TTRPG

Goss Income
Design Intentions

Mass of Debt is a corporate horror RPG where employees perform dangerous supernatural jobs for a company that owns their lives. Combat is chaotic and simultaneous. There are no attack rolls and no damage rolls. Every action pushes the situation toward a dangerous outcome. You're not playing poker. You're playing Russian roulette. And every chamber is loaded with a different bad outcome.

As the GM, this guide tries to make your job as easy as possible so you can have a stress free and fun experience alongside your players (who may not be stress free, but hopefully having fun).

Combat encounters are easy to design. Creating new characters, items, and quests should be seamless.

Player Archetypes & Play Styles

Embrace Every Player Type

Players come with different motivations:

- **Storytellers** thrive on wounds, stress, downtime, and exploration.
- **Problem-Solvers** will love environmental creativity and off-the-wall ideas.
- **Casual Players** will appreciate straightforward dice rolls, flash cards for abilities, and thematic gear.

Make sure every session offers some hooks for each style, and encourage them to lean into their character’s strengths.

Player Primer

Player Primer

Welcome to Employment

You’re not a hero. You’re not the chosen one. You’re a disposable hireling in service to a monster. Your employer is grotesque, powerful, and utterly indifferent to your survival. You’ll be sent on strange jobs: some are petty, some are cruel, most are dangerous. Failure means suffering. Success means the chance to grow into something stranger. And maybe someday you’ll get to pay off your debt. Please ignore the pile of corpses who all thought the same.

You’ll start small with a disturbing “gift” from your employer. The gift makes you dangerous to friends & foes alike.

What You Do

You and your group will carry out jobs, missions, errands, or atrocities. Some are subtle, some are violent, some are downright bizarre. Expect to:

- Face combat that can bleed, wound, dismember, and traumatize you.
- Spend your blood, stamina, and sanity to scrape through.
- Make choices that scar you or the people around you.

You’ll describe what your character does. The GM will set the stage and tell you when to roll dice or draw cards. There’s no grid, no inch-by-inch measurements—just the chaos of combat and the consequences of choice.

How the Game Feels

- **Fast and sharp.** Battles are around 2-7 rounds long with each round lasting 2-3 minutes.
- **Diabolical.** Wounds, dismemberment, and panic are part of your story.
- **Risky.** Resources deplete quickly. You’ll decide when to push your luck and when to retreat.
- **Collaborative.** Victory comes from teamwork. Combining abilities, leaning on allies, and making sacrifices. Lone wolves won’t last long.

Consequences

This game works best when players embrace the horror, laugh at the absurdity, and let consequences shape their character.

How to Be a Good Player

- **Be Bold.** Don’t hoard your tokens or second-guess every risk.
- **Share the Table.** Give everyone spotlight moments, whether in combat or downtime.
- **Accept Your Fate.** Wounds, Stress, and Panic keep the stakes high and make victory all the sweeter.
- **Collaborate.** You’re all stuck in the same nightmare.

Stress

Stress

Stress is accumulated as you lose rounds, suffer wounds, dismemberment, or bleed. If you spend or lose all of your Stamina Tokens, you gain Stress. Traumatic moments outside of combat can also stress you out.

Stress accumulates when you:

– Flee combat
– Suffer wounds, dismemberment, or bleeding
– Spend or lose all of your **Stamina Tokens**
– Endure traumatic moments outside of combat

Some **Combat Cards** will cause you to **Panic.** You'll roll 2D6, then add your **Stress** and subtract your **Resolve**.

Panic Attack (2D6 + Stress - Resolve)

Stress Total	Result
1-5	**Steady Nerves** - No effect as you steel yourself and press on.
6-7	**Shaken -** Ignore the next Positive Card result you take.
8-9	**Jittery -** Lose 1 Stamina Token.
10-11	**Hesitation -** You can't use abilities in your next round of combat.
12-13	**Lash Out -** You bleed or wound an ally.
14-15	**Despair -** You cannot reduce your **Stress** for 24 hours.
16-17	**Faint -** Collapse. You can do nothing until one round passes.
18-19	**Heart Attack -** Your heart stops and you collapse. You die in 2 rounds unless revived.
20+	**Retirement** - You've seen enough. Your adventuring days are done.

Skill Tests

Skills

Sometimes the GM will ask you to perform a skills check using your Might, Awareness, or Resolve. You simply roll that many dice, and count any 4+ as a success. If the number of successes meets or exceeds a certain value (determined by the GM), you're good.

Example: You want to climb a rope. The GM asks you to perform a Might check (difficulty 2). You have 3 Might and roll 3 dice getting a 1, 2, & 5. You only have 1 success, so you decide to spend a Stamina to reroll one of your failures. You end up getting 2 successes and climb the rope.

For the GM: Setting Difficulties

- **Easy (1 Success):** A task most competent people could do.
- **Standard (2 Successes):** A challenging task requiring skill and effort.
- **Hard (3 Successes):** A demanding task that would test an expert.
- **Heroic (4+ Successes):** A feat that would be legendary.

Stamina

Stamina

Stamina is a resource you can spend to reroll any d6 roll you make. Each time you roll, you may only reroll with Stamina one time. Any other abilities that would let you reroll can also be used in addition to Stamina.

Recovery

- **Long Rest**: Fully restore your Stamina
- **Short Rest:** Recover half your Stamina, rounded up.
- **Consumables**: Food and potions can restore Stamina
- **Abilities**: Some abilities can prevent loss of Stamina or restore it

If you spend or lose your last Stamina, you gain 1 Stress. If you would lose Stamina when you have none, you gain 1 Stress.

Magic & Spellcasting

Magic & Spellcasting

Magic is a rising tide of energy that you cultivate in combat. While powerful, it requires the most precious resource of all. Time. Every moment you tarry in the heat of battle might be your last. But for those with patience and a high risk tolerance, magic is a potent tool both inside and outside of combat. Will you delay one more round to ensure your spells go off without a hitch, or will you attempt the spell now, risking your own well being?

Out-of-Combat Spellcasting

To cast a spell outside of combat:

- Roll **2d6** and add your **Magic Counters**
- If the result is greater than or equal to the spell's **Level**, it succeeds
- If it fails, follow the spell's specific failure outcome
- Powerful spells typically have a cost (Blood, Gold, Stamina, or Stress)

In-Combat Spellcasting

Each round:

- You may cast one spell
- You start combat with an amount of **Magic Counters** equal to your **Prepared** level.
- You may use **Channeling** to generate **Magic Counters** by sacrificing **Power Dice**.
  With **Channeling** level 3, you could discard 3 **Power Dice** to gain 3 **Magic Counters**.

To cast:

- Roll **1d6 + Magic Counters**
- If the result is greater than or equal to the spell's **Level**, the spell succeeds
- If not, suffer the spell's specific consequence

Magic Counter Management

- **Channeling X**: Free Action. Once per round, sacrifice up to X Power Dice to gain that many *Magic Counters*.
- **Prepared X**: You always begin combat with at least X Magic Counters.

- At the end of an encounter, discard your **Channeled** Magic Counters

*You may spend **Stamina** to reroll any failed dice roll—including spellcasting.*

Character Creation

Character Creation

Your typical meatbag minion starts with:

3 Blood Tokens
6 Stamina Tokens
3 Focus Tokens
3 Melee Power
3 Ranged Power
0 Prepared
2 Channeling
2 + D3 Might
2 + D3 Awareness
2 + D3 Resolve
Gold = (16 - Might - Awareness - Resolve) * 50

All characters have the following team abilities that they can use together (The whole team must agree to use the ability):

Survive (Cost 1 Focus): Roll 1 more Power Dice this round. You cannot apply Positive card effects.
Regroup (Cost 1 Focus): Roll 2 fewer Power Dice this round to roll 2 more next round.

You'll acquire abilities and stats through completing milestones and rolling on the table below. Players should create a wishlist for the GM as to what kind of abilities and items they would like to receive.

1 – Increase Power, Prepared Magic, or Channeling
2 – Increase max Blood Tokens
3 – Increase max Stamina and Focus by 1
4 – Get a special ability
5 – Get a legendary item
6 – Choose from the above. The GM gets a Doom Point.

NOTE: Rolls on this table are for permanent progression and are immune to interference from **Stamina** and **Drunk Tokens**.

Choose a starting "gift" from your employer:

Touch: You steal the breath and sleep of everything you touch. While touching any creature that breathes, it cannot breathe. After touching any creature that sleeps, it won't be able to sleep the next night. You recover Stamina for every creature you touch. Your employer feels everything you touch.

Sight: You have a third eye that can see illusions, invisibility, and lies. You can also see up to 10 feet through walls. When you attempt to sleep and close your third eye, it might hurt. Your employer can see everything you see.

Taste: When you lick something, you taste its possible future.
When you consume part of a once-living thing, you experience flashes of its past – memories, emotions, fears.

Your jaw unhinges and your digestion is unnaturally resilient.
You can't always control your cravings.

Sound: You absorb all sounds within arms reach of you. They may be randomly released later, and possibly all at once. Once per day you can release the sounds and speak for 1 minute.

Smell: Your ability to smell is greatly enhanced to doglike levels and you can detect the desires of sentient beings. The smell of fear becomes intoxicating.

Life: You may restore a dead creature to life by touching its corpse, provided it died within the last hour.
The resurrected being remains alive only while you maintain physical contact. If contact is broken, it dies immediately.
In combat, only one of you may roll Power Dice and use abilities each round.
You may only have one such resurrected being at a time.

Death: While you are asleep, any creature that touches you dies. Your lifespan increases in accordance with how long they would have lived (you gain 1 year for every 10 they would have lived). You might sleepwalk at night.

Smile: You can wear the faces of your victims. Literally. You can easily peel the face off a humanoid creature and wear it as your own. You gain their voice & appearance, and your body shape changes to match theirs. The face rots in 6 hours and you revert to your normal appearance. Some faces become irresistible.

Despair:
Your tears are a slow-acting, undetectable poison.
Anyone who was truly happy immediately before or after consuming them will die within hours.
The poison remains active in their system for 3 hours once ingested.
Crying tears of joy is very dangerous for your health.

Vengeance: You may awaken with thoughts of vengeance against someone who has wronged you. You learn their location at all times and all doors that would stand between you and your victim are mysteriously unlocked. Your employer keeps track of every target you fail to kill.

Mercy: You can place a cursed mark on a willing recipient. You gain 1 gold every day for each living marked victim. Your employer failed to mention what the mark does.

Curious: Each dawn, you receive a vision of a person. A vague description, a location hint, and a felt presence. If you find them and persuade them to speak your true name three times, you learn one new ritual spell. That person may summon you by speaking your name three times.

Battle Creation

Battle Creation

You, the GM, set the stage for battle. The two big decisions you'll make are how the fight begins and how it ends. Before any dice are rolled, you choose the terms:

- How many enemies are there, and what kind?
- What's the terrain like?

Are the players facing a single deadly boss, a swarm of weak cultists, or a clever ambush of mixed types? Enemy composition is your main dial for difficulty and pacing.

When the fight ends, you also decide what that victory (or defeat) actually means—maybe the villain gets away. Maybe the players take prisoners. Maybe everything explodes.

Your job is to create **challenging, rewarding,** and **memorable** encounters. If everyone's having fun, it's perfectly fine to enjoy putting the players through hell every now and then.

Before combat begins, announce how many rounds the players must win to complete the encounter. Each round of combat follows these steps:

1. Declare engagement modifiers (Melee, Ranged, Freeform, High Ground, etc.)
2. Monsters & players use abilities and roll **Power Dice**
3. Determine winners and players draw from **Combat Deck**
4. Determine victory, retreat, or proceed to step 1

GM Guidance

- You have **many tools** to challenge your players—don't let rules lawyering be one of them.

- Combat is more fun when it's **tense but fast**. Let players talk, plan, joke, and shout ideas—but don't get bogged down in red tape.

- Remember: if the players are winning too easily, you can increase the round count, add new enemy abilities mid-fight, or escalate the scene with new threats or consequences.

Choke Point - (Only use melee power of strongest on each team)
Close Quarters - (Only use ranged power of strongest on each team)
Flanking / High Ground / Ambush / Cover - (+1 power die per member)

Your typical monster has 2 Blood tokens. You can scale up the number for bigger monsters.

You can vary monsters' ranged/melee power however you want, but here's some power level suggestions for monsters.

Goblin Menial = 2 Power
Joe from accounting = 3 Power

Woodsman = 4 Power
Bear = 5 power
Soldier = 6 power
Knight = 7 power
Royal guard = 8 power
Queen = 9 power
Big Monster = 10 power
Evil Wizard = 25 power
Beholder = 50 power
Vampire = 75 power
Lich = 100 power
Eldritch Horror = 1000 power

Combat Rules

Combat Round Structure

1. **Engagement & Terrain**
   Declare the type of combat (Melee-only, Ranged-only, or Free-choice), and apply any terrain modifiers (Choke Point, High Ground, Cover, etc.).

2. **Power & Ability Phase**
   The GM announces what the monsters are going to do. Everyone rolls their Power Dice and may use one of their abilities.

   - Each roll of 4+ counts as a **success**.

   - Players can coordinate and strategize freely—prioritize fast, fluid play. If there's ever a rules ambiguity, **rule in the players' favor** and move on.

3. **Win/Loss Determination & Combat Deck**
   Compare total player successes to total enemy successes.

   - If tied, it counts as a loss for the players.

   - Players draw **2 Combat Cards** (3 if Unarmored).
   - **If they won:**
     - If their hand contains **any Positive cards**, they choose one to apply.
     - If their hand contains **no Positive cards**, they choose one Negative card to apply.
   - **If they lost:**
     - If their hand contains **any Negative cards**, they choose one to apply.
     - If their hand contains **no Negative cards**, they choose one Positive card to apply.
   - **A card must always be applied.**

4. **Cleanup & Next Round**

   - Check for deaths, fainting, or player retreat.

   - If players choose to retreat, they roll on the **Retreat Table**.

   - If the players have won the required number of rounds, the combat ends.

     - You may narrate the enemy retreat, surrender, or player victory.

   - Otherwise, **start the next round at Step 1.**

Combat Tables

Combat Tables

Wounded

D6🎲	Where are you wounded?
1	**Eyes -** You are blinded next round (Don't roll on either win table)
2	**Arms -** Roll power with disadvantage
3	**Head -** Roll spells with disadvantage
4	**Legs -** If you flee battle, roll on the loss table twice
5	**Ears -** You are deafened
6	**Chest -** You cannot speak clearly. Your max Stamina is 1 until you're healed.

Dismembered

D6🎲	Where are you dismembered?
1	Leg / Equivalent
2	Arm / Equivalent
3	Hand / Equivalent
4	Foot / Equivalent
5	Eye / Equivalent
6	Ear / Nose / Equivalent

Retreat

D6🎲	What happens to you?
1	You die
2	You're dismembered & gain stress
3	You're wounded & gain stress
4	You bleed & gain stress
5	You lose Stamina & gain stress
6	You make a clean getaway

NOTE: You may spend Stamina to reroll on these tables.

Hope & Doom

The GM gains Doom Points (DP) when the following occurs:

- The players flee from a battle.
- The players fail to complete a job.
- A player selects the highest-reward milestone option.
- A player takes a selfish action that hurts their allies.

The GM can spend DPs to dramatically impact the narrative and difficulty:

1 DP: Send in reinforcements
2 DP: Players are attacked in the night
3 DP: A villain accelerates their evil plans
4 DP: Your employer demands significant tribute
5 DP: The players are betrayed by a former ally

Players collectively gain Hope Points (HP) when the following occurs:

- The GM offers the players Hope Points in exchange for more Doom Points.
- A player lets the GM pick a milestone reward for them.
- A player chooses to increase their character's *minimum* Stress by 1 (Once per character).
- A player character is dismembered for the first time.
- A player character panics for the first time.
- A player character drops to 0 Blood for the first time.
- A player character loses a loved one or friend (not a coworker).
- A player character pays off half their debt.
- A player character uses magic for the first time.
- A player character kills for the first time.
- A player character retires or dies.

The players can collectively agree to spend points to impact their survival and the narrative:

1 HP: Convert a Wound, Stun, or Bleed into Stress.
3 HP: A player character returns from the brink of death with 1 Blood Token.
5 HP: Find a map, key, or note that helps you with your current job.
8 HP: Counter a spell, ritual, or supernatural event.
10 HP: A player character learns a terrible secret about their employer. Their *minimum* Stress is increased by one. Set their Stress equal to their *minimum* Stress.

NOTE: Minimum Stress can never be reduced.

Conditions

Conditions

Name	Description
Nausea	Your max **Stamina** is reduced by 1.
Wounded	Roll one fewer **Power Dice** until your wound is healed.
Dismembered	Roll one fewer **Power Dice** until you regain your limb.
Stunned	You can’t use special abilities in the next round.
Comatose	You can do nothing until magic or medicine restores your consciousness.
Exhausted	When you roll **Dice**, reroll 6’s.
Festering	Your max **Blood** is reduced by 1.
Absent Minded	Your **Awareness** is 1 until this status is removed.
Weakened	Your **Might** is 1 until this status is removed.
Disillusioned	Your **Resolve** is 1 until this status is removed.
Power Overwhelming	You have the irresistible urge to cast one of your most powerful spells.
Bloodthirsty	You have the irresistible urge to kill something.
Lethargic	You have the irresistible urge to do nothing.

Rest & Relaxation

Rest & Relaxation

While evil never rests, pathetic mortals must. When you're not working, you may spend your free time consuming sustenance, recharging your cerebrum, or doing a pointless activity.

Rest & Eat (Up to 3 Times per day)

Name	Gold	Effect
Ration	1	Remove a **Wound** or gain a **Blood Token**.
Good Meal	5	Remove a **Wound** or gain a **Blood Token**. Repeat.
Lavish Feast	25	Remove a **Wound** or gain a **Blood Token**. Repeat 2x

Party (No Limit)

Name	Gold	Effect
Funkup	1	On a 6+, reduce **Stress**. Roll for every 30 minutes spent partying. Get a **Haze** token for every 30 minutes spent partying.
Narcrotic	5	On a 5+, reduce **Stress**. Roll for every 30 minutes spent partying. Get a **Haze** token for every 30 minutes spent partying.
Sublime	25	On a 4+, reduce **Stress**. Roll for every 30 minutes spent partying. Get a **Haze** token for every 30 minutes spent partying.

Sleep (Once per day)

Name	Gold	Effect
Camp	1	On a 5+, gain a **Stamina Token**, gain a **Blood Token**, or remove a **Wound**. Roll for every hour spent resting.
Soft Bed	5	On a 4+, gain a **Stamina Token**, gain a **Blood Token**, or remove a **Wound**. Roll for every hour spent resting.
Luxury Spa	25	On a 3+, gain a **Stamina Token**, gain a **Blood Token**, or remove a **Wound**. Roll for every hour spent resting.

Downtime (Once per day)

Name	Effect
Read Non-Fiction	You get advantage on a sensible idea
Read Fiction	You get advantage on a crazy idea
Journaling	Receive a hint from the GM
Practicing	Advantage on a **Power Roll**
Workout	Advantage on a **Might** check
Exploring	Advantage on an **Awareness** check
Meditating	Advantage on a **Resolve** check
Relax	Reduce **Stress** by one

Haze Tokens

- Gain **Haze Tokens** by drinking/taking drugs.
- Lose 1 **Haze Token** every hour you don’t party.
- The **GM** can spend players' **Haze Tokens** to force rerolls (any dice).

Healthcare

Healthcare

Since you are probably a squishy meatbag, you’re going to sustain flesh damage. Here are some items you can purchase to help mend your weak and pathetic form.

Name	GP	Description
Bandages	2	Gain a Blood Token. It takes a minute to apply.
First Aid	10	Remove a **wound**. It takes 10 minutes to apply.
Healing Potion	25	Gain a **Blood Token**. It takes an action to drink (or apply).
Energy Drink	10	Gain a Stamina Token. It takes an action to drink (or apply).
Lizard Lotion	50	Regrow a recently lost limb. It takes a minute to apply. Regrow hands and feet in 12 hours, legs and arms in 24 hours, and fingers or toes in 2 hours.

Wargear & Items

Wargear

Small Shield - You may reroll wounds and dismemberment. On a 4+ you may ignore a **Wound** or **Dismemberment**.
Large Shield - Once per combat, you may spend a **Stamina Token** to ignore a **Wound** or **Dismemberment**.

Business Casual - When you draw Combat cards, draw an additional one.
Business Professional - Once per combat, you may ignore a Combat cards' effects.
Business Formal - Every round of combat, you may ignore one negative effect from a Combat card.

Weapon Modifiers:

- **Lacerate** - When you wound an enemy, on a roll of 4+ you may bleed them as well.
- **Cleave** - When you wound an enemy, on a roll of 5+ you may wound another enemy as well.
- **Bludgeon** - When you wound an enemy, on a roll of 4+ you may stun them as well.
- **Fast Draw -** Roll one additional power on the first round of combat.

Item Creation

To create relics on the fly, roll on the vibe table and the function table. Then fill in the blanks with your imagination. Any overpowered items can have “quirks” popup later. Any underpowered items can have their potential unlocked later as well.

Relic Vibe

1. Fancy
2. Useful
3. Niche
4. Diabolical
5. Cursed
6. Useless… for now

Relic Function

1. Weapon / Bat / Gun / Shield / Staff / Wand / Quivver / Scabbard
2. Armor / Boots / Helmet / Gloves / Belt
3. Trinket / Wristwatch / Deck of Cards / Compass / Lucky Dice
4. Jewelry / Necklace / Tiara / Ring / Bracelet
5. Clothing / Cape / Coat / Hat / Scarf / Tie
6. Tool / Knife / Hammer / Rope / Tape / Flashlight

A Few Potential Item Bonuses
+1 to all power dice rolls
Reroll 1s
Double power dice, can’t roll next round.
4+ ignore a negative effect
4+ double a positive effect

Conditionals

When you get status
When you apply status
When you remove status
When you roll doubles
When you roll 1s
When you roll 6s
When you begin combat

When you win a battle
When you lose / flee battle
When an enemy casts spell
When an ally falls unconscious
When an ally dies
When you die
When enemy dies
When enemy gets status
When enemy removes status
When you roll the lowest power
When you roll the most power
When you win round
When you lose round
When you drink
When you sleep
When you eat

Tattoos, Birthmarks, Quirks, & Sigils

Unblinking Eye You can see the invisible.
Storm Scar You may treat the worst of weather as a clear sunny day.
Hound You can follow any creature's trail that is less than 10 minutes old.
Eagle Once per day, you may reroll a ranged power die.
Abstract You can quickly calculate distances, angles, and time accurately.
Maze You are never lost and always know where you are (unless teleported to another plane).
Dragon You have a good sense for when a venture will be profitable.

Abilities

Channeling X (1/2/3…)
Free Action: You may sacrifice X power dice each round before power dice are rolled. You get a magic token for each power dice sacrificed. You may cast spells of a level less than or equal to the number of magic tokens you have. At the end of combat, discard your magic tokens.

Prepared X (1/2/3…)
You start fights with X magic tokens.

Overpower
After you have cast a spell, when enemies roll power dice, you may force them to reroll X power dice where X is the casted spell's level. You may only use this once per sleep.

Monkey See
When you see/hear a ritual being cast, you can remember that spell for 1 hour (you must write it down to keep it).

Tough As Nails
After combat, remove a bleed or wound.

Tactician
You roll an extra Power dice when fighting on high ground, choke points, and close quarters.

Onslaught
When rolling Power dice, 6's count as two successes.

Power Through
Once per sleep, ignore a stun.

Get Down!
If an ally would take a wound, bleed, be stunned, or be dismembered, you may choose to suffer instead.

Inspiring Violence
When you kill an enemy, you may restore an ally's stamina.

Two Birds with One Stone
Once per sleep, when you kill an enemy, kill another.

Feel No Pain
Once per sleep, ignore a wound.

True Grit
Once per sleep, ignore a Panic Attack.

Just a Flesh Wound
Once per sleep, turn a dismemberment into a wound.

I am Death
Once per sleep, if you would die, kill an enemy instead.

Everything's a Weapon
Improvise a weapon out of almost anything solid.

Victory or Death

Once per sleep, you may choose to roll up to 3 more power die. For each additional die you roll, if you lose the round, you get an additional bleed.

Boss Creation

Boss Creation

You as a GM will be roleplaying as an employer of horrific nature. You will send your minions (the players) to perform evil deeds through coercion, promises, fear, and sometimes violence. While the employer shouldn't care about the players' well-being in a personal sense, they should care about them as tools. The employer can sound charming and supportive of the players, while never mourning the loss of any of them. For example, you may inflict punishment on a player while stating that it's only "fair" because Bob from accounting (who still has his index fingers) never made that mistake. You can of course have the employer enjoy being cruel, and more cruel than is necessary.

You can use the following tables to roll out what "qualities" your job creator has.

Form / Body (Roll once or twice and combine)

1. Human in shape only
2. Clockwork precision hiding organic horror – Their movements are perfect, but their insides leak.
3. A feeling made manifest – Regret, hunger, sorrow, desire. You don't see them, you feel them.
4. A voice penetrating your soul – You hear them in your bones
5. Beautiful and terrifying – They are perfect and they know it.
6. Repulsive and well dressed – They reek, rot, and drip, but their cuffs are clean
7. Larger than you can comprehend – Turning your head doesn't seem to help
8. A mirror with people trapped inside it – They speak in unison.
9. A swarm pretending to be one thing – Rats, crows, snakes, insects
10. Mummified something – Was that a tentacle you saw?
11. A sentient dungeon – The walls are breathing
12. An abomination of flesh – Its misery is matched only by its glee

Wants / Needs (Roll twice, no duplicates)

1. Knowledge
2. Power
3. Recognition
4. Legacy
5. Worship
6. Transcendence
7. Aesthetic / Beauty
8. Chaos
9. Companionship
10. Revenge
11. Souls
12. Blood
13. Control
14. Sanity
15. Identity
16. Purpose
17. Prophecy Fulfillment
18. Balance

19. Expansion
20. Material

Hates (Roll one to three times, no duplicates)

1. Light
2. Darkness
3. Mirrors
4. Music
5. Laughter
6. Questions
7. Answers
8. Nature
9. Machines
10. Order
11. Chaos
12. Beauty
13. Ugliness
14. Cleanliness
15. Filth
16. Gods
17. Ignorance
18. Knowledge
19. Odors
20. Sensations

Moment to moment temperament:

1. Amused — rewards recklessness.
2. Hungry — demands more.
3. Indifferent — ignores prayers.
4. Curious — grants a hint or vision.
5. Displeased — adds Stress to all.
6. Ecstatic — twists reality in your favor.

Job Creation

Job Creation

As a just and benevolent job creator, it is your duty to create tasks for your ~~slaves~~ employees to perform. This section is to help you design and create jobs for your minions.

Make a Subtle Change

- Rotate all portraits in a castle 3 degrees *clockwise*
- Wrinkle a lords clothing
- Spoil only the left side of a feast
- Unsync all clocks by 3 minutes

Plant / Swap / Steal

- Plant a cursed locket on a mayor
- Swap a brewery's vats with *seawater*
- Steal a saint's fingernail from a reliquary
- Replace the queen's favorite tea with boiled silence

Perform a Strange Ritual

- Write diagrams on the walls in invisible ink
- Throw salt on somebodies shadow after they sneeze from pepper
- Desecrate the gravestones of everyone with the letter A in their name
- Bury a live crow under the crossroads at noon

Torture

- Teach children a lullaby that summons something
- Bake a birthday cake with sand in it
- Remove one page from every book in a library
- Engage in terrible smalltalk with a target until they run away

Manipulate / Blackmail

- Convince a priest to speak blasphemies
- Blackmail a knight with a doppelganger's love letters
- Gaslight a scholar into doubting their own name
- Coerce a Lord to object to marriage.

Murder / Death / Kill

- Murder a bard who sings off key
- Dig up the deceased and swap their bodies
- Kill every cow with an odd number of spots
- Rewrite a final testament and will

Explorer

This is only an archetype, not an actual class. The following ideas are here to make sure I'm covering different archetypes. These abilities can be used/obtained by any character.

Good for exploiting the environment
Can make potions and things from stuff the party finds
Can carry more stuff and knows what different stuff is
Expert on stuff

Combat Deck

21 Negative cards
22 Positive cards
Every negative card has 2 effects to make armor choices interesting

Negative	- Lose a Blood Token </br></br>- Lose a Blood Token
Negative	- Lose a Stamina Token </br></br>- Lose a Blood Token
Negative	- Lose a Stamina Token </br></br>- Lose a Stamina Token
Negative	- Lose a Stamina Token </br></br>- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table)
Negative	- Lose a Stamina Token </br></br>- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round)
Negative	- Lose a Stamina Token </br></br>- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table)
Negative	- Lose a Stamina Token </br></br>- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table)
Negative	- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table) </br></br>- Lose a Blood Token
Negative	- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table) </br></br>- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table)
Negative	- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table) </br></br>- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table)
Negative	- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round) </br></br>- Lose a Blood Token
Negative	- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round) </br></br>- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table)
Negative	- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round) </br></br>- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round)

	</br></br>These stack
Negative	- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round) </br></br>- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table)
Negative	- You are Stunned </br>(Can't use abilities next round) </br></br>- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table)
Negative	- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table) </br></br>- Lose a Blood Token
Negative	- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table) </br></br>- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table)
Negative	- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table) </br></br>- Lose a Blood Token
Negative	- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table) </br></br>- You Panic! You gain Stress </br>(Roll on the Panic table)
Negative	- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table) </br></br>- You have been Dismembered </br>(Roll on the Dismember table)
Negative	- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table) </br></br>- You have been Wounded </br>(Roll on the Wound table)
Positive	- You deliver a killing a blow
Positive	- You wound an enemy
Positive	- You stun an enemy
Positive	- You bleed an enemy
Positive	- An enemies will falters (Resolve check, difficulty 2)
Positive	- You gain a Stamina Token
Positive	- Reduce your Stress
Positive	- You wound an enemy </br></br>- You stun an enemy
Positive	- You wound an enemy </br></br>- You bleed an enemy

Positive	- You wound an enemy </br></br>- An enemies will falters (Resolve check, difficulty 2)
Positive	- You wound an enemy </br></br>- You gain a Stamina Token
Positive	- You wound an enemy </br></br>- Reduce your Stress
Positive	- You stun an enemy </br></br>- You bleed an enemy
Positive	- You stun an enemy </br></br>- An enemies will falters (Resolve check, difficulty 2)
Positive	- You stun an enemy </br></br>- You gain a Stamina Token
Positive	- You stun an enemy </br></br>- Reduce your Stress
Positive	- You bleed an enemy </br></br>- An enemies will falters (Resolve check, difficulty 2)
Positive	- You bleed an enemy </br></br>- You gain a Stamina Token
Positive	- You bleed an enemy </br></br>- Reduce your Stress
Positive	- An enemies will falters (Resolve check, difficulty 2) </br></br>- You gain a Stamina Token
Positive	- An enemies will falters (Resolve check, difficulty 2) </br></br>- Reduce your Stress
Positive	- You gain a Stamina Token </br></br>- Reduce your Stress

Spell List

Combat Spells

Level 3 – Needle Hex
Roll a D6. On a 4+, Wound one enemy.
Failure: You are Wounded.

Level 5 – Crimson Spray
Roll once per enemy. On a 4+, they Bleed.
Failure: You bleed.

Level 7 – Surge of Fury *(Costs 1 Stamina)*
An ally doubles their Power Dice this round.
Failure: You gain 1 Stress.

Level 8 – Cull the Weak *(Costs 1 Blood)*
All enemies rolling 3 or fewer Power Dice are instantly slain.
Failure: You are Stunned.

Level 9 – Burden of Power
You gain 1 Stress. All enemies rolling 4+ Power Dice are Wounded.
Failure: You are Wounded.

Level 10 – Gilded Pain *(Costs 5 Gold)*
On a 2+, Stun, Wound, and Bleed one enemy.
Failure: You die.

Level 11 – Lifesteal *(Costs 2 Blood)*
Up to three allies gain 1 Blood Token. All enemies lose 1 Blood Token.
Failure: You die.

Level 12 – Crimson Overdrive
Up to 3 allies lose 1 Blood Token and roll double their Power Dice this round.
Failure: You die.

Level 13 – Show Stopper
Your heart stops. All allies restore their Stamina Tokens. All enemies are Stunned.
Failure: You become Comatose.

Level 14 – Final Offering
You die. Distribute 10 Blood loss among enemies however you choose.
Failure: A random ally dies.

Ritual Spells

Intent (What it does)

Roll or choose one:

1. Summon — Call forth something that shouldn't come.
2. Bind — Trap, compel, or restrain a target.
3. Reveal — Expose truth, memory, or hidden things.
4. Transform — Change the nature or shape of something.
5. Protect — Shield, preserve, or delay destruction.
6. Destroy — Unmake, banish, or erase.

Quick GM Ritual Table (d6):

Offering (What it costs)

Roll or choose one:

1. Blood — Yours or another's.
2. Flesh — Scars, limbs, or organs.
3. Memory — Forget something you love.
4. Emotion — Give up fear, joy, or empathy.
5. Time — Age forward, lose hours, or forfeit years.
6. A Precious Object — An heirloom, promise, or possession that mattered.

Interference (How it misbehaves)

Roll or choose one:

1. Works, but maybe *too well*.
2. Something inside you *twists*.
3. Only works under *specific conditions*.
4. The *cost increases* with each use.
5. Leaves an *evidence trail* leading to you.
6. Creates an *unstable magical residue*.

Example Combat

Example Combat

The GM decides the players will have to win 2 rounds of combat for the fight to conclude. They then inform the players of what they are up against, being as vague as they wish.

Round 1:
The GM states that the round is Ranged Only. Players roll their Ranged Power Dice and count their successes (Every 4+ counts as a success). The GM rolls Power Dice for the monsters. The players have more successes and have won the Round (The GM keeps a tally of how many rounds they have won). The players each draw 2 cards from the combat deck. If there is a Positive card, they apply its effects, otherwise they apply either negative cards effect. The players decide to keep fighting.

Round 2:
The GM states that the round is Freeform as the monsters close the gap (Ranged or Melee Power Dice). Players roll their Melee or Ranged Power Dice (whichever is greater) and count their successes. The GM rolls Power Dice for the monsters. The players have fewer successes and have lost the round. The players each draw 2 cards from the combat deck. They choose any negative card and apply its effect. If there is no negative card, they apply one of the positive cards' effects. The players decide to continue fighting.

Round 3:
The GM states that only one player may use Ranged Power Dice (It's close quarters fighting now). All but one of the players roll Melee Power Dice and count their successes. The GM rolls Power Dice for the monsters. The players have more successes and win the round. The GM declares they have won the battle and asks the players if they want to take prisoners, kill stragglers, or let the monsters go.

Archetypes

Archetypes

Sometimes, you just want to play somebody who smashes faces or has an insatiable love for the dead. Rather than taking milestone rewards, you might bargain with your employer to receive a group of abilities that work together.

Necromancer

Necromancer

Flesh economy. You don't waste resources; you re-use them. Convert body parts into resources & minions.
Turn your own severed limbs into extensions of yourself. Replace your own body parts with better ones you find. You can be Frankenstein and the monster.

Handyperson
You may dismember your hand to gain a small agent that can move around and do as you wish. It can see objects (but not colors) within 5 meters of itself. It can wear rings and gloves; is capable of cutting and sewing. And can carry small objects. You may only have one such agent at a time. Should you create a new one, the old one simply becomes a dismembered hand.

I'm All Ears
You can hear with every part of your body. Even if it is severed from the whole. This lasts up to 24 hours, or as long as the part is "animated".

Send Friend Demand
You can turn a humanoid corpse (or an ensemble of parts) into a dumb but loyal servant. It has roughly the intelligence of a dog and all of its stats are degraded. It's incapable of using tools beyond hitting things with them. At the start of each day, you get one stress for every "friend" you've created. If you don't feed your "friend" 2kg of meat every day, they become your enemy. When you draw from the Combat deck, draw an additional card for each participating "friend" but only apply one more of them. If you have no "friends" ignore this.

It Looks Better On Me
You may take dismembered arms, legs, eyes, & ears from your enemies and attach them to yourself. If the arm or leg belonged to somebody mightier than you, you gain 1 might. If the ear or eye belonged to somebody with more awareness, you gain 1 awareness. You must remove your own limb before attaching the new one and it takes an hour to sew on and attach. Should you lose that limb, you cannot regrow it with Lizard Lotion.

Seamstress
Every time you gain stress, roll a D6. On a 1, you lose a stitched limb (you choose the limb).

Spy

Spy

You are a double agent working for your true master to steal power from your false master. You can fake your death to turn “corrupted” gifts from your false master into “pure” gifts from your true master. You then return to the party as a new recruit with a new face. As a spy, you are a master in disguises, illusions, traps, and poisons. You’re adept at winning the first round of combat, scouting, pickpocketing, picking locks, and appraising items.

Ambusher
Gain 3 power dice in the first round of combat if you weren’t seen or heard.

Slippery
Once per sleep, negate a wound, stun, or bleed.

Light Footed
You make no sound if you aren’t wearing heavy armor.

Shadowplay
Once per sleep, if you are the target of an ability, you may instead have that ability target an illusion of yourself. You had the illusion ready to go somehow…

Twist the Knife
When rolling Power dice, for every two 6’s you roll, you automatically deal Bleeding.

From the Shadows
If you are heavily obscured by darkness or cover, roll an extra ranged power dice.

Cloak and Dagger
If you won the previous round, you can’t be bled or wounded.

Tricks of the Trade
Advantage against traps. Advantage when setting traps. Advantage when lock picking. Advantage when pickpocketing. Advantage against poisons. Advantage with poisons.

Sucker Punch
Once per combat, you may stun an enemy.

Must Have Been My Imagination
Once per sleep, if you failed a stealth check, you may succeed instead.

Uninvited Guest
Doors are never locked for you. Whether it’s sleight of hand, dumb luck, or divine mischief… you always find a way in. In addition, you intuitively know the layout of the first floor you enter—even if you've never been there before.

You Need This Less Than I Do
When you leave a place you weren’t invited into, the owners forget about one small item you’ve taken—so long as it’s not obviously valuable. A half-eaten pastry, a spare key, a folded map, a few coins, a letter on a desk… gone, and nobody notices it’s missing. *Some say it’s sleight of hand. Others say it’s some kind of twisted charm. You say it’s just fair trade.*

I Spy With My Third Eye
Twice per sleep, you may ask the GM to give you the direction to the nearest treasure trove. They can answer with North, Northeast, Up, Down, etc.

Druid

Druid

This is only an archetype, not an actual class. The following ideas are here to make sure I'm covering different archetypes. These abilities can be used/obtained by any character.

Some transformation stuff
Similar to Wizard but more nature, summoning, and transformation focused

Cleric

Cleric

This is only an archetype, not an actual class. The following ideas are here to make sure I'm covering different archetypes. These abilities can be used/obtained by any character.

More healing, preventative, and protection focused than the wizard

TODO

Write a one-paragraph “What this game is about” statement
Define a single default play experience (tone, pacing, stakes)
Add hard defaults for combat length (e.g. 2-4 rounds)
Add a difficulty ladder with named tiers and default dice values
Make difficulty inputs explicit (numbers, terrain, morale)
Move hidden difficulty to an optional/advanced rule
Convert all “GM decides” moments into listed outcomes
Add a combat setup checklist for the GM
Add a one-page GM quick-start
Add example combats with commentary
Add default interpretations for win/loss results
Separate core rules from advanced options
Add a campaign phase loop (engagement → fallout → downtime → escalation)
Add persistent pressures (stress, scars, obligations, reputation)
Add downtime actions with concrete effects
Define what character progression looks like long-term
State explicitly what the system does not support
Add genre module templates instead of genre rules
Add a first-3-sessions onboarding path
Reduce or remove rules that exist only to be flexible

Corporate Jargon

Gross Income — Corporate Jargon Reference

A GM's Guide to Sounding Like a Monster in a Suit

Employer Praise & Rewards

The employer never compliments you directly. They compliment your *output*. They frame everything as if you should be grateful. The praise always implies that more is expected.

- "I want to recognize the *outstanding initiative* shown on last night's assignment. Not everyone would have the stomach for it. Literally."
- "You've really exceeded expectations this quarter. I'm moving you to a higher-priority account. The last team didn't survive it, but I have a good feeling about you."
- "This is exactly the kind of proactive problem-solving we value here. I'm putting you on the fast track. Don't ask where the track goes."
- "You've earned a wellness day. Please use it. You look *terrible*."
- "I took the liberty of updating your personnel file. You now have a commendation. And a new debt."
- "I'm awarding you Employee of the Month. The plaque is made from the previous winner."
- "Great hustle out there. Really best-in-class dismemberment. I'm going to loop in the shareholders on this one."
- "As a token of my appreciation, I've approved a one-time discretionary bonus of 2 gold. Please sign the attached waiver."
- "Your performance review is glowing. I wrote it myself. You should be honored — I don't usually bother learning your names."
- "I see leadership potential in you. And I mean that in the most *concerning* way possible."
- "Consider this a battlefield promotion. Your predecessor's desk is still warm."
- "You've demonstrated real alignment with our core values. I'm genuinely impressed. That should frighten you."

Employer Punishment & Discipline

Punishment is never called punishment. It's *feedback*. It's *realignment*. It's a *growth opportunity*. The employer is never angry — they're *disappointed*, which is worse.

- "I'm not upset. I'm *recalibrating my expectations*."
- "Let's not think of this as a punishment. Let's think of it as an aggressive course correction."
- "Per our previous conversation, I believe I was *very clear* about the deliverables. Your fingers were not among them, and yet here we are."
- "I've scheduled a one-on-one to discuss your recent performance. Please bring your own bandages."

- "This is a verbal warning. The next one will not be verbal."
- "I'm placing you on a Performance Improvement Plan. The 'improvement' is mandatory. The 'plan' is mine."
- "I want to be transparent with you — and I use that word *very carefully* — your work has been below expectations. Let's discuss what you're willing to lose to fix that."
- "There will be no disciplinary action at this time. I simply wanted you to know that I noticed. I always notice."
- "I'm reassigning you. Think of it less as a demotion and more as... relocation to a higher-risk environment."
- "I appreciate your honesty about the mistake. That said, honesty has a cost here. Check your pay stub."
- "I don't micromanage. I simply remove the things you care about until your priorities *align with mine*."
- "You're not in trouble. Trouble implies there's a process. This is just between us."

Corporate Terminology for Horrific Events

The company has a word for everything. None of the words are honest.

What Happened	What They Call It
Someone died	Involuntary separation / Permanent offboarding / Career conclusion
Someone was murdered by the employer	Termination (and they never clarify which kind)
Someone lost a limb	Partial asset reduction / Non-critical structural loss
Someone went insane	Unsanctioned creative thinking / Cognitive restructuring
A massacre	Aggressive downsizing / Workforce optimization event
Torture	Enhanced debriefing / Intensive feedback session
A suicide mission	High-visibility opportunity / Career-defining assignment
Raising the dead	Talent reacquisition / Post-termination rehire
Human sacrifice	Stakeholder contribution / Value extraction
Demonic summoning	Unscheduled shareholder meeting
A building full of people was destroyed	Campus consolidation
Feeding someone to the employer	Executive dining

Poisoning someone	Competitive wellness initiative
A teammate was eaten	They've been *absorbed* into upper management
Someone is being haunted	Unsolicited mentorship
Betrayal	Strategic realignment of loyalties
Fleeing in terror	Leaving your work area
Crying	Unauthorized bereavement
Begging for your life	Renegotiating your contract
The building is alive and screaming	Facility feedback
Any traumatic event	Critical incident

Forms

Every form exists. Every form *works*. That's the problem. The company's bureaucracy is nightmarishly efficient — you will get exactly what you asked for, and you will regret it. The GM can reference these by name, and players can file them during downtime. The results are always mechanically real and always come with a cost the form doesn't mention.

- **Form 1-A: Incident Report (Non-Fatal)** — File this to formally report a workplace incident. The company investigates thoroughly and resolves the situation in your favor. The resolution is *disproportionate*. You reported a coworker for shoving you; the coworker is no longer with the company. No one will tell you what happened. Your other coworkers are quieter around you now.
- **Form 7-C: Limb Loss Claim** — File this after losing a limb on the job. You receive your limb back, fully functional, plus an additional one. The form does not specify where the extra limb is attached, whose it was originally, or whether it matches your species. It performs perfectly.
- **Form 12-F: Request for Time Off (Unpaid)** — Approved immediately. You may not return to work until the employer allows it. Could be a day. Could be a month. Your debt continues to accrue. Your coworkers are sent on jobs without you. Some of them might not come back. You wouldn't know.
- **Form 12-G: Request for Time Off (Paid)** — Approved immediately. You receive double your normal pay for the duration of your absence. Your next mission is twice as difficult. The employer considers this a fair exchange.
- **Form 3-B: Grievance Filing** — You may file a grievance against any coworker or supervisor. If the grievance is legitimate — if you were genuinely wronged — the company rules in your favor. Decisively. File a grievance against your supervisor for taking your rations, and one of their limbs shows up in your next meal. Justice is served. You didn't ask for it to be served like *that*.
- **Form 9-D: Expense Reimbursement** — You may claim expenses incurred during a job, including medical costs, ammunition, and bribes. You receive 100% of the submitted cost in cash. Your debt increases by twice the amount. The reimbursement is technically a loan. The paperwork for the loan is Form 9-D.

- **Form 6-A: Death Certificate (Employee)** — Pre-filled with your name. Just needs a date.
- **Form 6-B: Death Certificate (Target)** — Requires cause of death, time of death, and a "customer satisfaction" rating from 1-5.
- **Form 15-E: Voluntary Overtime Agreement** — The word "voluntary" is in quotes on the actual form.
- **Form 22-A: Workplace Hazard Acknowledgment** — A single page that reads: "I acknowledge that my workplace may contain hazards including but not limited to: structural instability, cursed artifacts, sentient mold, involuntary transformation, temporal displacement, and management. Signed: ___"
- **Form 11-G: Equipment Requisition** — You may request a specific piece of equipment. You receive it. It is exactly what you asked for, in perfect condition. It performs flawlessly — even when you don't want it to. The sword that never misses also never *stops*. The lantern that lights any darkness also lights things that were dark for a reason. The lockpick that opens every door opens *every* door.
- **Form 4-R: Return to Work (Post-Death)** — For employees who have been resurrected, reanimated, or otherwise restored. Includes a section for "current number of functioning organs" and "do you still identify as your original species." Filing this form is required within 48 hours of reanimation. Failure to file results in your death being finalized retroactively.

Policies

These should be referenced casually by the employer or found posted on walls in company facilities. They're absurd but just plausible enough to sound like real corporate policy.

- **The Open Door Policy** — The employer's door is always open. You may enter at any time. Many employees enter. Fewer leave. This is considered a feature of the policy.
- **Mandatory Fun** — Once per quarter, the company hosts a team-building event. Attendance is mandatory. Past events include: trust falls into darkness, a three-legged race (participants started with four legs), and a potluck where the main course was "a surprise."
- **Zero Tolerance for Workplace Violence** — Violence not sanctioned by the employer is strictly prohibited. Sanctioned violence is encouraged and tracked for performance metrics.
- **The Dress Code** — Business Casual is the standard. "Casual" is defined as "whatever you can still wear after your last assignment." Blood is acceptable if it's yours. Someone else's blood requires a change of clothes within the hour.
- **Anti-Fraternization Policy** — Romantic relationships between employees are discouraged. Not because the employer cares about your feelings, but because attachments create *leverage*, and the employer prefers to be the only one with leverage.
- **The Whistleblower Policy** — Employees are encouraged to report misconduct through proper channels. The proper channel is a locked box in the basement. The basement has been sealed since an incident the company does not acknowledge.
- **Sick Leave** — Employees receive 0 paid sick days. Unpaid sick days may be taken but will be deducted from your debt repayment schedule. "Sick" is defined narrowly. Missing a limb is not sick. Being on fire is not sick. Death is *one* sick day.
- **The Non-Compete Clause** — Upon leaving the company, you may not work for a competing employer for a period of eternity. The company defines "competing employer" as "anyone who would hire you."
- **The Employee Handbook** — Distributed on your first day. 400 pages. Written in a language that shifts between readings. Key sections include: "Your Rights (Abridged)," "Acceptable Losses," and "Appendix F: What Happens If You Run." No two employees have received the same version.

- **Annual Review Cycle** — All employees are reviewed annually. Ratings range from "Meets Expectations" to "Exceeds Expectations" to "Has Drawn the Employer's Attention." The last rating is not a compliment.

Job Titles

These are titles the players or NPCs might hold. They should sound mundane and corporate while describing something horrible or absurd.

Player-Level Titles (Low Ranking)

- **Field Associate** — You go where they tell you and do what they say.
- **Junior Acquisition Specialist** — You steal things.
- **Grief Counselor** — You cause grief. There is no counseling.
- **Compliance Officer** — You make people comply. By any means.
- **Sanitation Technician** — You clean up after the *other* employees. The messes are not always physical.
- **Stakeholder Liaison** — You talk to people before bad things happen to them. Sometimes you *are* the bad thing.
- **Account Closer** — Exactly what it sounds like. Both definitions.
- **Risk Assessment Analyst** — You go in first.
- **Client Relations Specialist** — You maintain relationships. When the client dies, the relationship ends. This is noted in your file.
- **Temp** — Below even the players. Not on payroll. Not given equipment. Technically not even an employee. Still expected to die for the company if asked.

Mid-Level Titles (NPCs, Veteran Employees)

- **Senior Vice President of Controlled Demolition**
- **Regional Director of Involuntary Relocation**
- **Head of Quiet Acquisitions**
- **Managing Partner, Anomalous Assets**
- **Chief Morale Suppression Officer**
- **Director of Preemptive Solutions**
- **Vice President of Anticipated Losses**

Upper Management (Rarely Seen, Deeply Wrong)

- **The Board** — No one has seen The Board. Decisions come down from The Board. The Board may not be people.
- **Executive Vice President of Long-Term Vision** — Has been in the role for 300 years. Looks 40. Don't ask.
- **Chief Ethics Officer** — This position exists on the org chart. It has never been filled. It *cannot* be filled.
- **The Shareholders** — They were promised things. They are waiting. Their patience is not infinite.

Useful Phrases for General Conversation

These are things the employer or company NPCs might say in passing. Not tied to a specific situation — just the ambient hum of corporate horror.

- "Let's take this offline." (Said before dragging someone into a dark room.)
- "I want to be transparent with you." (They are about to lie.)
- "We're a family here." (Families can't quit.)
- "This is a safe space." (It is not.)
- "I have an open-door policy." (See above.)
- "Let's not point fingers." (They are absolutely going to point fingers.)
- "We value your input." (Your input will be ignored.)
- "Going forward..." (Everything before this word is being erased.)
- "At the end of the day..." (The day never ends here.)
- "We need to right-size the team." (Someone is about to be *removed*.)
- "Let's circle back on that." (You will never speak of this again.)
- "I hear you." (They do not hear you.)
- "That's above my pay grade." (Said by someone with no pay grade. Said *to* someone with no pay grade.)
- "Let's put a pin in that." (The pin is literal. The pin is cursed.)
- "It's not personal, it's business." (It is extremely personal.)
- "We're pivoting." (The plan failed and no one will admit it.)
- "I'll loop you in." (You are being added to a problem, not a solution.)
- "Per my last email..." (The email contained a threat you did not recognize as a threat.)
- "Just to close the loop..." (Someone is being *closed*.)
- "We should synergize on this." (Two departments are being merged. One will not survive.)